

TRAIN WITH **TAKU**



TRANSFORM YOUR BODY FROM HOME

Full training and nutrition guide (FREE
PROGRAM INCLUDED)



A REALISTIC HOME TRANSFORMATION

Jan 2021 - April 2021 (100% self-coached)



Back in early 2021, gyms were closed for the *third time* and my motivation was at an all time low. But then something switched in me. **I stopped worrying about the circumstances, and changed what I could control.** With the right approach, and mindset, you CAN transform your body from home. Don't let a busy work schedule or a "gym intimidation" be a barrier to success. **This short book will outline principles to transform your body and mind from the (dis)comfort of your home.** **Enjoy!**

04 Muscle Anatomy – What do our muscles actually do?

06 6 tips to ACTUALLY get results training at home

08 Nutrition for fat loss and gaining muscle gain (+ example meals)

12 Special techniques for training at home

13 3-day HOME TRAINING PROGRAM

16 Want to learn more?

MUSCLE ANATOMY

What do our muscles actually do?

Pectoralis Major ("Pecs")

Functions: Move arms from the side of the body to the centre, raise arms in front of you (upper chest), lower arms from the side (lower chest)
Exercises: Push ups, dips

Anterior deltoids ("Front delts")

Functions: raise arms in front of you
Exercises: Shoulder press, push ups, dips

Lateral deltoids ("Side delts")

Functions: Raise arms to the side
Exercises: Lateral raises

Rectus Abdominus ("Abs")

Functions: Bend torso forward, stabilise torso and spine
Exercises: Sit ups, crunches, Plank, leg raises

Biceps Brachii ("Biceps")

Functions: Bend arm, twist hand so palm faces up/forward
Exercises: Curls

External obliques:

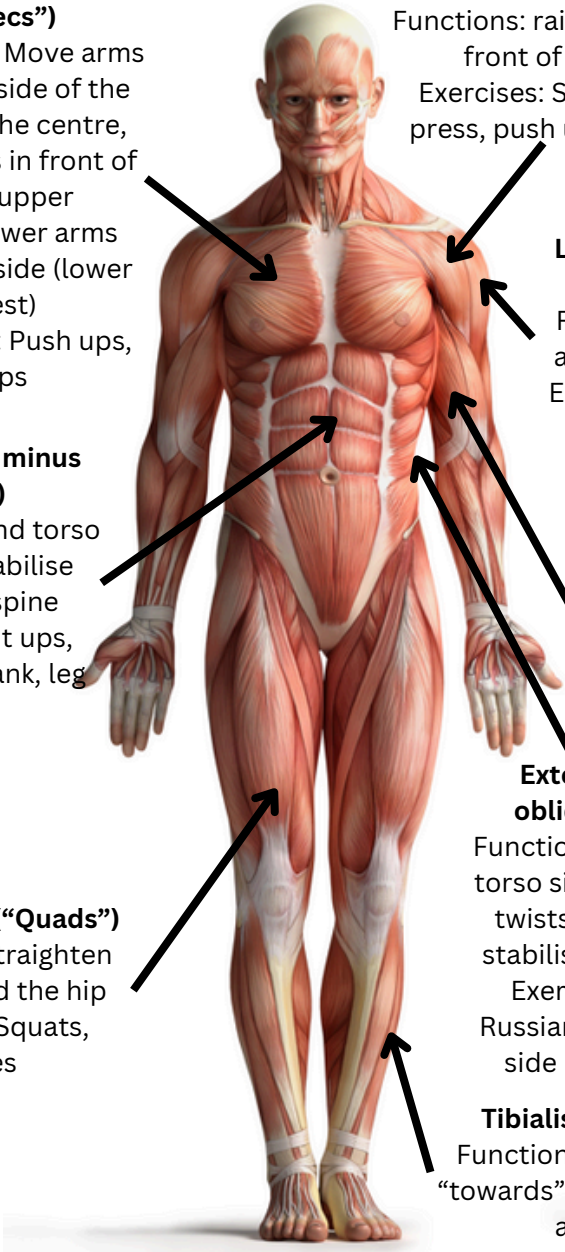
Functions: Bend torso sideways, twists torso, stabilise spine
Exercises: Russian twists, side bends

Quadriceps ("Quads")

Functions: Straighten the leg, bend the hip
Exercises: Squats, lunges

Tibialis Anterior:

Functions: Point toes "towards" you, stabilise ankle



MUSCLE ANATOMY

(Rear view)

Latissimus Dorsi (“Lats”)

Functions: Move arms behind you from the front, or towards your body from the side
Exercises: Rows, pull ups, pulldowns

Forearm muscles

Functions: Bend wrists, grip
Exercises: Rows, pull ups, hammer curls, reverse curls, wrist curls

Gluteal muscles (“Glutes”)

Functions: Extend/rotate the hip
Exercises: Deadlifts, Romanian deadlifts, goodmornings, glute bridges

Trapezius (“Traps”)

Functions: Lift/lower shoulders, squeeze shoulder blades
Exercises: Rows, Pull ups, shrugs

Posterior deltoid (“Rear delts”)

Functions: Move arms behind you from the front, rotate arms from the middle to the side of your body
Exercises: Rows, Pull ups, reverse flies, pull ups

Triceps Brachii (“Triceps”)

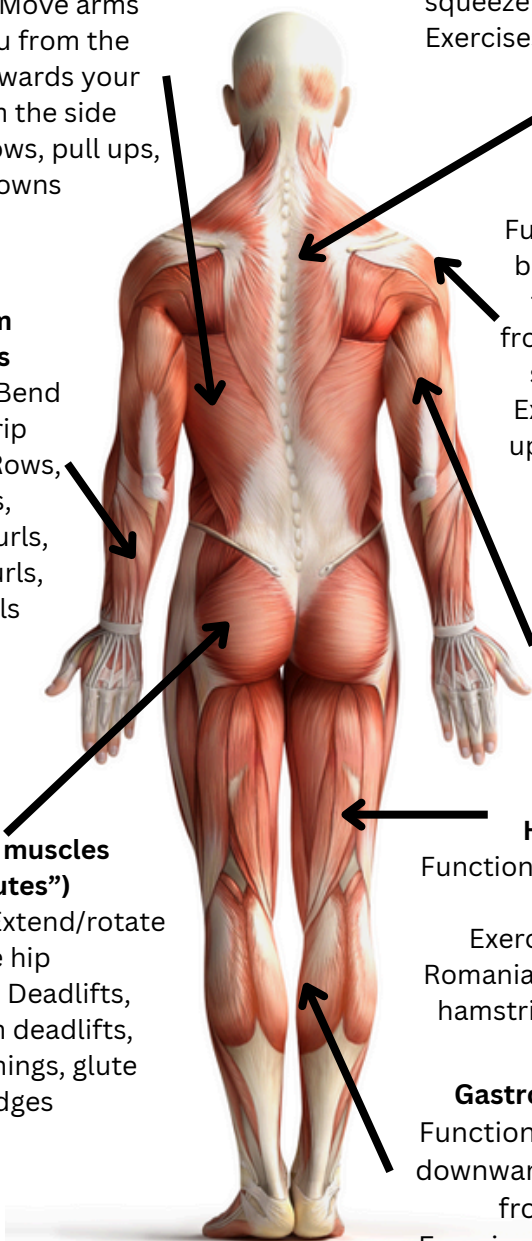
Functions: Straighten arm
Exercises: Close-grip push ups, tricep extensions

Hamstrings

Functions: Bend leg, extend hips
Exercises: Deadlifts, Romanian Deadlifts, nordic hamstring curls, leg curls

Gastrocnemius

Functions: Point toes downwards or “away” from you
Exercises: Calf raises



CHAPTER 1

6 tips to actually get results training at home

1) Know your reason: Know your “why”. This is different for everybody. You may be preparing for wedding photos, or maybe you just want to keep up with your kids in the park! This will help you stay committed, even at times when motivation is low. ?

2) Goal setting: You should have goals which are **measurable** so you can track progress more objectively. For example, if you want to lose fat, a related performance goal could be improving your 5k run time. A related habit goal could be only having 1 snack in between meals instead of 2. If you wish to improve the size of your pectoral (chest) muscles, a performance goal could be to improve the number of push ups you can perform, and a habit goal could be to have 3-4 servings of lean protein a day. ***Focus on performance and habit goals and your aesthetic goals will come as a by-product.***

3) Chase the small wins: This links closely with point 2. Your most important piece of equipment is your **notebook**. After every set you do, note down how many reps you did, and the amount of weight you used. That gives you objective numbers to try and strive to beat the next time. Go for the extra rep. Add that kilo. Even if you don't beat your targets every time, the intention should be there. This can be psychologically beneficial, because even at times when the scale, or the mirror don't look like they're changing much, these provide objective indicators that you are still making progress.





4) Train through the “struggle zone”: Muscles require a very potent stimulus to grow. If you’re training the muscles hard enough, there will come a point when reps naturally start **slowing down (THIS IS KEY)**. I call this the “**struggle zone**.” Milk the struggle zone for as long as you can. ***Keep doing reps until you are physically unable to perform any/many more reps (while maintaining good form)***. With home workouts, it may take longer to get to this point because the weight you use will be lower than in a gym, so the reps will be naturally higher. **High-rep sets are associated with a “burning” sensation.** However, just because you start feeling a burn doesn’t necessarily mean you are in the “struggle zone”, and consequently, people often stop their sets too early (especially with high rep sets). You will need to learn to endure the burn and truly get to the “struggle zone” to stimulate significant growth.

5) Prioritise compound exercises: These are exercises that use more than one muscle group/ joint at once. They have the most transferability to day to day activity as they train you to use your body as a unit. They should be the bread and butter of any exercise program. An example would be a push up, which uses the chest (pectoralis major), arms (triceps), shoulders (anterior deltoids) and other muscles which stabilise the body.

6) WALK MORE!: You should aim to have a more active lifestyle **in addition** to working out. Walking is great for cardiovascular health, mental health, and it’s easy on recovery so it won’t interfere with your resistance training sessions. If you work from home, or in an office, start with going for a 10-20min walks during your lunchbreak. As a minimum, strive for **8000 steps daily** and gradually increase it.



CHAPTER 2



Nutrition: Fat loss and muscle gain

Calorie deficit: This means that you consume less energy (i.e. fewer calories) than you expend. ***It is the underlying principle for every fat loss diet that exists***, no matter how people spin it. Keto. Intermittent fasting. Low carb. None of these are magic. They are different methods of getting into a calorie deficit. Once in a calorie deficit, your body will look for other sources of energy such as ***fat, glycogen*** (carbs stored in the muscles/liver) or ***muscle tissue***. Assuming your goal involves improving your body composition, you want to **maximise fat loss and minimise muscle loss**. Food **quantity AND quality both matter**. I will explain some principles for you to apply to help you make decisions with your food.

How many calories should I eat to lose fat?: This depends on many factors. Mainly your *bodyweight, sex, age, amount of muscle mass, and activity levels*. The starting point is to work out how many calories you would eat to maintain weight. There are some very complex equations out there, but I will give you a simple method. It's not perfect but gives you somewhere to start. **Take your bodyweight in lbs (or bodyweight in kg x 2.2) and multiply it by 14-15 if you work from home or in an office (x14 female, x15 male). If you work a manual labour job, or you regularly play a sport, multiply it by 15-16 (x 15 female, x16 male).** This will give a VERY, VERY rough estimate of your **maintenance calories**. Maintenance calories are the number of calories you would eat to maintain your current bodyweight. **If you want to lose fat, a starting point would be to consume 10-20% below that number.** See the example below. You could use a food scale and an app like MyFitnessPal to track. ***Don't worry. If the thought of weighing food makes you sick, you can find some tips that don't involve tracking calories on the next page.***

E.g. 75kg male office worker

Maintenance calories = $75 \times 2.2 \times 15 = 2475\text{kcal}$ (10% = 248, 20% = 496)

Fat loss calories: $2475 - 248 = 2227\text{kcal}$ (10% deficit)

$2475 - 496 = 1979\text{kcal}$ (20% deficit)

Macronutrients explained: Macros are the source of all calories. These are **protein, carbohydrates, and fats**. The food we eat will be composed of different proportions of these 3 nutrients, and that will determine the amount of calories in the food. **For reference, carbohydrates and protein both each have 4kcal per gram, and fat has 9kcal per gram (alcohol has 7kcal per gram).** For example, if 100g kidney beans has 14g carbs (14x4kcal), 8g protein (8x4kcal), and 1g fat (1x9kcal) there would be around 97kcal total calories. You will notice a slight difference on nutrition label, but if you do the maths, the numbers will be close.

Protein intake: Protein is VERY important whether you're trying to lose or gain weight. In a fat loss phase, protein helps with muscle maintenance/gain whilst eating in a deficit, hence increasing it will be beneficial. Additionally it's very filling, hence it will help you better adhere to your nutrition plan. A good rule of thumb is consuming **1.5 - 2 g of protein per kg of bodyweight per day (e.g. 80kg person: 120g - 160g protein per day)**. Prioritize lean, lower fat protein sources (lean mince, skinless chicken, lentils, beans etc). If you have a very high amount of bodyfat and at a particularly high bodyweight, it may be hard to hit this protein target (protein is FILLING). An alternative in this scenario would be 1.5-2g of protein per kg of your GOAL bodyweight (e.g. if 70kg is your goal bodyweight, consume 105 - 140g protein/day). **If you don't track calories/macros, have 3-5 servings of lean protein sources per day.**

Fibre: Fibre contains 0 calories, and it is very filling. THIS IS A DREAM when on a fat loss phase. You can feel full without adding significantly to your daily calorie target. Fibre supports digestion, bowel movements and lowering of LDL cholesterol. A good rule of thumb is that for every 1000 calories you consume, there should be at least 15g of fibre. In short, eat your fruit and veggies. Eat at least 5 portions of a wide range of fruit and vegetables per day. **If your goal is to lose fat, without tracking calories, at meal times, fill up half of your plate with a high fibre food (e.g. lettuce, kale).**

****NB:** The majority of your food choices should be single-ingredient, or at least have minimal processing. These are generally more nutritious and more filling, helping you adhere to a deficit.*



LOSE FAT WITHOUT TRACKING CALORIES

[Click to view](#)



FAT-LOSS FRIENDLY LOADED FRIES

596kcal (72g carbs 38g protein, 18g fat)

[Click to view](#)



FAT-LOSS FRIENDLY HIGH-PROTEIN PIZZA

567kcal (62g protein, 44g carbs, 15g fat)

[Click to view](#)

Can I lose fat and build muscle at the same time?: Yes. This is feasible in 3 scenarios. **1)** You are a beginner to *consistent training* - Your body is extremely primed for new muscle growth. **2)** You have a large amount of bodyfat - plenty of energy reserves, even when eating in a calorie deficit. **3)** You are coming back to training after a long period of time off.

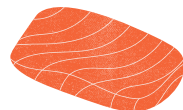
However, if you're somebody who wishes to gain weight/size, and you have struggled to in the past, you have NO REASON to eat in a calorie deficit. The most efficient way to build size would be to eat in a calorie surplus (consume more calories than you burn). Now, this is not an excuse to have McDonald's every day (the health implications are not worth it). When gaining weight, you want to maximise muscle gain and minimise fat gain. A sensible amount of calories would **5 - 10% above your maintenance calories**. This will help enhance recovery and help you progress quicker in your resistance training sessions. You should still prioritise whole, single ingredient foods. If you're somebody with a low appetite, look for *calorie-dense whole foods*. Great examples include avocados, salmon, nuts, seeds, peanut butter (100% natural peanut butter), and olive oil. **You should still be consuming a variety of fruit and vegetables** to get a sufficient amount of micronutrients. Protein should still be high to support muscle growth (1.5g / kg bodyweight).



PEANUT BUTTER RICE, BEEF STEW AND VEG

953kcal (97g carbs, 71g protein, 29g fat)

[Click to view](#)



CHAPTER 3

Training techniques for home training

Rep goal system: You do all sets for as many reps as possible with a goal total number in mind. If you hit that target, you increase the weight next time. For example, imagine your total rep goal is **40 reps across 3 sets**. Do 3 sets for as many reps as possible and add all the reps together. If the total equals 40 or more, you can add weight next time you do the exercise. If you get less than 40, you'd keep the weight you use the same next week.

Single-leg exercises: For example, lunges, Bulgarian split squats, and step-ups. The muscles in your legs are some of the strongest in your body, and they can handle a high amount of load. Single-leg exercises are important for giving them a sufficient challenge to stimulate growth, as well as develop balance.

Weighted stretch: Where possible, use exercises that take your muscles through a large path of motion to get an extra stretch. For example, deficit push ups. Studies have shown that training muscles at long lengths can stimulate more growth. We can use this to make home training more efficient. For example, doing push ups with your hands on elevated platforms to allow your chest to come down further.

Pyramid “down” sets: Choose a top number. For example, **“20 to 1”**. Choose a lightweight that you can comfortably do 20 reps with. Take a short rest (e.g. 20 - 30 seconds) and then do 19 reps. Rest again and do 18 reps. Do this all the way down to 1. The burn will be crazy! This is a great way to accumulate lots of reps, which is necessary if training with lighter weights at home.



HOME TRAINING PROGRAM

(Follow the number of **reps suggested in this book** - reps suggested in videos may be different.)

Day 1 - Full Body workout

- 1 - Bulgarian split squats 3 x 8 - 15 per leg
- 2 - Deficit push-ups: 3 x AMRAP (Rep goal 40)
- 3 - Single-leg Romanian deadlifts 3 x 12 - 15
- 4 - Single-arm rows (lat-focused) (3 x 8 -12)



1 - Bulgarian Split Squats



2 - Deficit Push ups



3 - Single-leg Romanian deadlifts



4 - Single-arm rows

Day 2 - Conditioning and accessories

- 1 - Bicep curls (15-down)
- 2 - Overhead tricep extensions (15 to 1)
- 3 - Lateral raises: 3 x 15 - 20
- 4- 10min circuit



1 - Bicep Curls



2 - Tricep Extensions



3 - Lateral raises

Then do this 10 minute circuit:

Burpees - 40 seconds, rest 20 seconds
then

Star jumps (or skipping) 40 seconds, rest 20 seconds
then

High knees 40 seconds, rest 20 seconds

3 rounds

Day 3 - Full Body workout

1 - Squats: 15-down

2 - Close-grip push ups: 3 x AMRAP (Rep goal 40)

3 - Good mornings (15 to 1)

4 - Double-arm rows (upper-back focused) (15 to 1)

5 - Single-arm bicep curls



1 - Squats



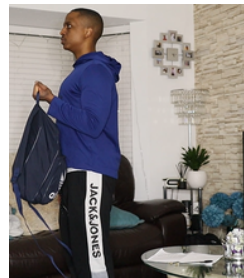
2 - Close grip push ups



3 - Good mornings



4 -Double-arm rows



5 - Single-arm bicep curls

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That's right, I come to you! **Scan the QR-code** and complete a **5-minute** online form (or you can send a text/email) and I'll be in touch to confirm details.



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